ASSIGNMENT 1

GET vs POST in Web Development

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Introduction

HTTP methods define how a browser or client communicates with a web server. Two of the most commonly used methods are GET and POST. Although both are used in web applications, they serve different purposes.

1. GET Method

GET is used to request or retrieve data from a server. Any parameters are commonly included in the URL, so they may appear in the browser address bar and history. GET is suitable for searches, filters, and viewing information, and it should not be used to change server data.

Example:

```
GET /students?id=10 HTTP/1.1
Host: example.com
```

2. POST Method

POST is used to send data to a server for processing. The submitted data is commonly placed in the request body rather than the URL. POST is often used for form submissions, account creation, and sending data that may create or change a resource. POST alone does not encrypt data; HTTPS is still required for protection in transit.

Example:

```
POST /students HTTP/1.1
Host: example.com
Content-Type: application/json

{"name":"Ahmed","age":20}
```

3. Main Differences

Feature	GET	POST
Main purpose	Retrieve data	Submit data for processing
Data location	Usually in the URL query string	Usually in the request body
Bookmarking	URL can often be bookmarked/shared	Submitted body is not part of the URL
Typical use	Search and view data	Submit forms or create resources

Conclusion

GET is generally used to retrieve information, while POST is used to submit information to a server for processing. Choosing the appropriate method helps make a web application clearer and more reliable. Sensitive data should always be protected using HTTPS, regardless of the method.

References

Createivo. (2026, April 16). *What is the difference between GET and POST, and when should each be used?* https://createivo.com/blog/difference-between-get-and-post